This light version of Irish stew has a richly aromatic broth. Lamb's neck—good value and meaty, with just enough flavorful fat—is best for this soup.

lamb broth

SERVES 4 **PREP** 20 MINS **COOK** 1 HR 45 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS

6 neck of lamb cutlets
1 celery rib, including leaves, cut into chunks
1 parsnip, cut into chunks
1 large carrot, cut into chunks
1 large floury potato, peeled and chopped
3 large scallions, chopped
3 large sprigs of flat-leaf parsley plus 2 tbsp finely chopped parsley, to finish
sea salt and freshly ground black pepper
1 small green cabbage, cored, leaves shredded
a few allspice berries
a few black peppercorns
Irish soda bread, heated in a low oven, to serve

1 Put the lamb in a large saucepan or stockpot. Cover it with cold water to 2in (5cm) above the meat. Add the celery, parsnip, carrot, potato, scallions, and 3 sprigs of parsley. Season with salt and pepper. Bring to a boil over medium heat, reduce the heat, partially cover, and simmer gently for about 1 hour. Remove any foam that forms at the top with a slotted spoon. Remove from the heat. Lift out the meat and set aside until cool enough to handle. Separate the meat from the bones, reserving the meat.

2 Skim any surface fat from the broth. Lift out and discard the parsley sprigs. Add the meat, cabbage, allspice berries, and peppercorns. Cover and return to a simmer over low heat for about 5 minutes. Taste, season if required and stir in the chopped parsley. Serve very hot with warm Irish soda bread.



SCALLIONS
When shopping for scallions—also called spring onions—look for crisp ones with firm stalks. Avoid if dry and brown on the outer skin, or if the green tops are browning or yellowing.